

The Longhouse , Bali



RATING	
VALUE	9.0
LOCATION	9.0
SLEEP QUALITY	9.0
CLEANLINESS	9.0
SERVICE	9.0
ROOM	9.0
TOTAL SCORE	9.0

Price: US\$975 - \$1675 per night

City: Bali

Hotel Type: Luxury villa

Stars: 5 stars

✓ **PROS:** Unique hilltop location, excellent views of Jimbaran Bay, plenty of space for 12 people

✗ **CONS:** Slightly remote location, steep uphill drive

Verdict

A timeless 6-room villa perched on the top of the Bukit Peninsula, enjoying 180-degree bird's eye view of the Jimbaran Bay, Bali.

Posted May 16, 2017

By Nellie Huang

With a spectacular 180-degree panorama of the coast, The Longhouse has a wow factor unlike no other. From its large open-concept living area, the narrow body of water that separates the Bukit Peninsula from the rest of the island is clearly visible over the tree canopy and a chain of majestic volcanoes loom in the distance. As night falls, the view of the island's southern plains shining with twinkling lights is particularly spectacular.

I had the privilege to stay at The Longhouse with my husband, our two-year-old baby, and my in-laws — and we were ridiculously spoiled by the villa's team of 14 staff. From the moment we arrived, we were lavished with an endless stream of drinks and fruit. The chefs also whipped up amazing breakfasts and decadent meals that made us want to stay in more than head out and explore.

Location

Perched high on the very top of the Bukit Peninsula, The Longhouse enjoys an elevated, hilltop location, from which you can enjoy possibly some of the best views of the island. From such lofty heights, it's easy to feel as if you've got the whole of Bali beneath your feet.

While the drive up to the villa can be quite steep and intimidating, it's actually within a short driving distance from many attractions, including the Uluwatu Temple that's famous for its sunset and traditional kecak dance. Jimbaran Bay is even closer, at just 10 minutes away by car. Safe, shallow swimming and excellent roadside seafood stalls (only open in the evenings) are what this popular stretch of Bali coastline is famed for.

Interior & Design

Designed by renowned Balinese architect, Popo Danes, The Longhouse is a three-storey masterpiece of contemporary tropical design. The six-room villa has a timeless design that perfectly blends modern features with natural, locally sourced building materials. Integrating the natural contours of the Bukit Peninsula, this spacious villa is an intriguing maze of thatched roofs, lush gardens and cascading water features. Evocative interiors reflect the owners' love of their adopted island home, with hand-picked textiles, furnishings and antiques collected during extensive travels across the Indonesian archipelago.

The atmospheric living room on the upper floor melds seamlessly with the infinity pool just steps away, and the villa's six generous bedrooms are each imbued with their own unique Indonesian flavour. The villa's long narrow design gives similar stunning views from every room and this, combined with a delightful garden, convivial dining room, air-conditioned gym, spa room and home theatre, makes The Longhouse a perfect holiday retreat.

Facilities

With six bedrooms and plenty of lounging and living space, the villa can easily accommodate up to 12 people (and even more with some smart arrangement) and makes for a perfect place to host a wedding party or birthday bash. The timber deck at the front of the garden on the lower floor is set below a romantic, flower-draped pergola, with extra-special birds-eye views over Bali. It's the ideal setting for an intimate and romantic celebration.

For our family, The Longhouse's amenities were perfect in every sense of the word. My two-year-old daughter Kaley had lawns and gardens to run around in, a huge pool to splash in, and a well-stocked indoor play area. The play area is equipped with toys, books and games; and the villa has plenty of kids' facilities including a baby cot; high chair; car seat and pool fence (on request).

While there's no TV in the living area or in the bedrooms, the media room offers the screen time children enjoy that also provides relief for us parents.

The butler, Happy, was brilliant at preparing meals for our daughter, who's quite fussy when it comes to food. The cooks also prepared amazing and lavish breakfasts for us each morning — my favorite being The Longhouse signature pancakes that included plenty of fruit, palm sugar syrup and coconut flakes that was just a heavenly concoction. Besides breakfasts, the cooks are equally adept at whipping up Italian, Asian, Moroccan and Balinese feasts from a suggestion menu or grilling up a seafood barbecue.

Overall Experience

We couldn't have asked for a better setting to kick back and enjoy Bali at its best. The Longhouse truly blew our mind with its spectacular view, personalized service and truly luxurious interior. We loved being pampered by the amazing staff here and it made us feel very privileged to be here. We know we'll be returning in future — but next time, we'll be sure to bring more friends and family, to enjoy this big living space.



The front view of The Longhouse



The Longhouse by night



The open concept living area



Sofa and eating area



The main dining area



The view from The Longhouse's swimming pool



The view from The Longhouse



Beautiful welcome drinks and banana fritters



The Longhouse's signature pancake with fruit, palm sugar and coconut



The large sofa at the living area



An entirely open living space



The massive dining table can sit up to 12



The largest room in the villa



Four poster beds with a view



The large bathroom in our room



Soaking in the private plunge pool off our bathroom



Our private plunge pool



A bedroom on the lower floor



Another spacious bedroom on the lower floor



Bathroom with a view



Another gorgeous room



With a stone bathroom out on its front porch



One of the twin rooms



Another twin room that's suitable for kids



The beautiful verandah in the garden downstairs



The media room that's great for watching movies together as a family



The kid's play area

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